

BO Decision Request: Edge Cases & Error States

Context: Design and engineering for Sprint 5 are blocked on two product policy decisions. These aren't UX calls — they depend on how we want OTEP to treat officers in restricted or empty scenarios. Need BO sign-off before Amber can design and eng can build.

Needed by: Before Sprint 5 planning (Thu 26 Jun)

Decision 1 — Ringfenced opportunities: hide or show-but-disable?

What is ringfencing?

Agencies posting on OTG can restrict their opportunity to a specific audience — by agency, job family, or job function. This is configured at posting time via OTG's Audience Setup step and enforced via the officer's POCDEX profile.

Two audience modes exist in OTG:

- **Limit to** — opportunity is only open to a named group (e.g. MOH and MOE officers only)
- **Exclude** — opportunity is open to all except a named group (e.g. all officers except the posting agency's own staff)

MVP scoping recommendation: support "Limit to" only for pilot. Agencies needing exclusion logic will be asked to reframe as an inclusion list or open the opportunity to all. "Exclude" deferred to R1. Rationale: inverted eligibility check introduces different failure modes; pilot agency set is small enough to manage manually.

The decision: when an officer who is NOT eligible lands on a ringfenced opportunity (under "Limit to"), what do they see?

Option	Experience	Trade-off
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A. Hide from listing entirely	Ineligible officers never see the opportunity — filtered out at the API level, no frontend changes needed	Cleaner experience, no confusion. Simpler to build (no POCDEX call in the detail page hot path). But officers can't discover opportunities they might become eligible for.
B. Show in listing, block apply on detail page	All officers see the opportunity card. Ineligible officers click through and see: "This opportunity is not open to you." Apply button is disabled.	More transparent — officers understand the full landscape. Requires POCDEX eligibility check at page load. Needs a fallback state if POCDEX is unavailable.

Michelle's lean: Option B — show but disable. Officers benefit from knowing what exists even if ineligible today. Hiding creates a perception the platform is incomplete. The detail page explanation manages expectations.

Questions for BOs:

1. Do you agree with Option B (show but disable)?
2. Any agency or comms implications — e.g. will agencies object to ineligible officers seeing their postings?
3. Do you foresee any pilot agency needing "Exclude" mode? If yes, we need to plan how to handle their postings at launch.

4 undiscovered questions — need to tie down:

4. Can agencies stack criteria?

OTG's Audience Setup shows Agency and Job Family & Function as separate tabs. Can an agency apply both at once — e.g. "MOH officers AND job family = Policy"? If yes, the eligibility check isn't a single field match — it's a compound condition. Pow Hwee needs the full criteria matrix before he can estimate the build.

- ☐ **BO to confirm:** can ringfence criteria be stacked (agency + job family)? What combinations are supported?

5. Can the audience be edited after posting?

If an agency changes their "Limit to" criteria after an opportunity is live, officers who already saw it (or bookmarked it) may find their eligibility has changed. We haven't confirmed whether OTG allows post-publish audience edits and how OTEP should handle mid-flight changes.

- ☐ **BO to confirm:** can agencies edit their audience setup after an opportunity is published? If yes, does OTEP need to handle the "was eligible, now not" scenario?

6. How specific should the ineligibility message be?

Option B shows "This opportunity is not open to you" — but how much should OTEP tell the officer about why? Two options:

- Generic: "This opportunity is not open to you." — safe, no exposure of ringfence criteria
- Specific: "This opportunity is limited to officers from [Agency / Job Family]." — more helpful, but exposes criteria the agency may want kept private

- ☐ **BO to confirm:** are agencies comfortable with OTEP surfacing their ringfence criteria to ineligible officers? Or should the message stay generic?

7. Should OTEP surface a positive eligibility signal for eligible officers?

The flip side of show-but-disable: when an officer IS eligible for a ringfenced opportunity, should OTEP tell them? Options:

- Silent: eligible officer sees a normal detail page with no indicator — they don't know it was restricted
- Explicit: show a positive signal, e.g. "This opportunity is available to you" — increases confidence to apply, but tells the officer the opportunity was restricted

- ☐ **BO to confirm:** do agencies want OTEP to signal positive eligibility? Any concern about advertising that an opportunity is restricted to a group?
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Decision 2 — Empty listing: what does an officer see if there are no active opportunities?

When does this happen?

If the pilot launches with no live opportunities in the system (e.g. agencies haven't posted yet, or all opportunities have passed their closing date), the listing page would be empty.

The decision: is this a real scenario for the pilot, and if so what should the officer see?

Option	Experience
A. Not a real scenario — pilot agencies will always have live postings at launch	No empty state needed. Park this for post-MVP.
B. Real scenario — show an informative empty state	"No opportunities available right now. Check back soon." No CTA needed.

Question for BOs: at pilot launch, will there always be at least one live opportunity in the system? If yes, we park this. If no, we need a design.

What's already decided (no BO input needed)

- **Closed opportunities** — excluded from the listing entirely. Only reachable via a direct link (stale bookmark). Handled by existing "no longer available" screen.
 - **API errors** — standard error screen with retry. No policy call needed.
 - **Incomplete officer profile** — descoped from MVP. Personalisation is not in MVP scope.
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Linked to:

Raise at: next BO Working Level session or async before Thu 26 Jun

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